Isabel MacGinnitie

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Paul G. Allen School
University of Washington
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♢ EDUCATION

2026 – Present **University of Washington**, Seattle, WA
PH.D. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING
Advisor: Max Kleiman-Weiner
Relevant Coursework: Social Reinforcement Learning

2019 – 2023 **Harvey Mudd College (HMC)**, Claremont, CA
B.S. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE & MATHEMATICS
Relevant Coursework: Empirical & Experimental Philosophy; Critical Inquiry: Animal Studies

♢ HONORS & AWARDS

2025 NSF CSGRAD4US GRADUATE FELLOWSHIP (3 years of funding)
2023 CS DEPARTMENTAL AWARD FOR COMPUTATIONAL CREATIVITY, HMC

♢ RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am broadly interested in AI alignment research that promotes humanity's ability to learn, advance, and flourish in a world with transformative AI, with a focus on caretaking, cooperation and moral progress.

♢ ACADEMIC RESEARCH

9/26 – Present **Computational Minds and Machines Lab**, Seattle, WA
GRADUATE RESEARCH ASSISTANT
Advisor: Max Kleiman-Weiner

Investigating how models make decisions on the behalf of humans in a multi-agent coding environment, focused on AI caregiving and empowerment.

9/21 – 12/22 **HMC Department of Computer Science**, Claremont, CA
UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH & SUMMER REU
Advisor: Lucas Bang

Approximated logical depth as an intuitive image complexity metric using compression algorithms and timing methods.

♢ FELLOWSHIPS & PROGRAMS

8/26 **Cooperative AI Summer School**, Toronto, ON

11/25 – 4/26 **Athena AI Alignment Fellowship**, Remote/Hostačov, CZ
Investigated how models can use emojis and filler tokens to obscure chain-of-thought.

4/25 – 7/25 **Futurekind AI for Animals Fellowship** (now Sentient Futures)
13-week program in AI safety and animal ethics; designed a project on value coherence in LLMs using animal ethics.

♢ INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

1/25 – 10/25 **RetroRate**, San Diego, CA
Software Engineer (first hire)
Built full-stack real estate platform to make housing more affordable through assumable mortgages.

10/23 – 7/24 **Color Health**, Burlingame, CA
Software Engineer
Modernized frontend infrastructure for genetic testing reports and NIH All of Us project.

5/21 – 8/21 **Microsoft**, Redmond, WA
Explore Intern, Azure Edge + Platform

♢ TEACHING

1/21 – 5/23 Teaching Assistant, HMC
Computer Vision (2 semesters), Programming Languages, Data Structures

8/20 – 5/23 Writing Center Consultant, HMC